



Gearing up for the world stage

Not just making products for India, says Noise founder **Amit Khatri**

Aman Rashid | editor@digit.in

For those who are not aware, most people know Noise for their sheer dominance in the affordable Indian smartwatch market. But the brand has also gotten quite serious about premium audio lately, especially in the last couple of years. With their partnership with Bose and the unveiling of the Master Buds 2 at CES, it's pretty clear that the company no longer wants to just focus on high-volume sales, but also take a crack at design-led products.

Amit Khatri, Noise founder, and I also chatted about the origin of Noise, how they are integrating AI into wearables, and their plan to take an Indian brand to the global stage. Here is the full conversation.

Q How did Noise begin, and where does the company stand today?

A Amit: We started close to ten years back. Our thesis back then was based on a huge gap we saw in the market. Whenever we or someone we knew travelled abroad, we used to ask them to bring something back because there were only the big global brands or cheap Chinese knock-offs available here. That is where the origin of Noise happened. We wanted to see if we could bring something for an Indian user who is willing to pay for a better quality product and a better design.

As an organisation, we have really evolved. We started as a mobile

accessory brand, and today we are among the top five brands globally for wearables, specifically smartwatches. We are also among the top three brands in the country for truly wireless audio devices. We believe we should be offering an ecosystem of devices to users. The Indian market is growing, and customers are very educated because of digital media. If you offer them a good product and experience, they are willing to pay for it.

Q What made audio such an important focus area?

A Amit: We are into consumer devices, and I believe that in the coming time, voice is going to play a very big role. The way we interact and talk to our devices, voice will be a major part of that. Audio comes from there. I never look at a company as just a smartwatch or audio company; it is an ecosystem. Smartwatches allow every consumer to pair an app with a watch, which gives us access to their consumer patterns. In the AI era, audio will help us give them a 360-degree ecosystem experience. It is about building connected devices, whether it is audio, watches, rings, or whatever form factor comes next.

Q How do you see earbuds changing over the next few years?

A Amit: All consumer devices will become companion devices. People will not want to buy 'dumb' devices

that only do one job. You won't have one device for taking notes and another just for music. They will be smarter, connected to an app ecosystem, and will stay updated over time through software. Instead of opening my phone to type, I should be able to tap my earbuds and say, 'Hey Noise AI, I am meeting Aman from Digit, tell me more about him.' Nobody wants to type anymore.

Q If we look ahead, where do you see Noise in the next five years, both as a brand in India and in terms of its global ambitions?

A Amit: Five years is too far now in this journey, but I can comment on the next two to three years. We announced our latest launch at the global CES. This is a signal to the world that Indian brands are no longer just making products for the country. We have the capability to produce competitive hardware, partner with global brands, and create well-designed products. We are gearing up for the world stage. In three years, we want a strong global presence where Indian brands are seen as equal competitors for international brands. **d**

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